UKM25M303
Operations Management
Module 3, 2025-2026

Course Information

Instructor: Dr Chaoran Liu

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Office Hour (Module 3):
Monday 11:30 – 12:30, Thursday 11:30 – 12:30
Wednesday 10:00 – 12:00 (On Microsoft Teams)

Classes:
Lectures: Monday/Thursday 13:00 – 15:30 pm
Venue: Conference Room

1. Course Description

1.1. Context

Course overview:

The objective of this course is to provide students with an understanding of how the design, operation, and control of production/operation systems can most effectively produce and/or deliver goods and services to meet customers' needs. This understanding will help business major students to be familiar with the problems and issues confronting operations managers in real business, and provide them with language, concepts, insights and tools to deal with these issues in order to gain competitive advantage through operations.

This course will emphasize applications rather than theories. However, the underlying logic of the concepts will be examined so that students will understand the principles upon which their approach is based.

1.2. Textbooks and Reading Materials

Jacobs, and Chase, Operations and Supply Chain Management –14th Edition, Irwin/McGraw Hill, 2014, ISBN-13: 978- 9339204105.

References:

1. Slack, Chambers, Johnston, "Operations Management," Prentice Hall, 4th Edition, 2004, ISBN-13: 978-1405807630
2. Heizer, Render, Munson, "Operations Management: Sustainability and Supply Chain Management", Person International Edition, 12th Edition, 2016, ISBN-13: 978- 0134471815

2. Learning Outcomes

2.1. Intended Learning Outcomes

Learning Goals	Objectives	Assessment (YES with details or NO)
1. Our graduates will be effective communicators.	1.1. Our students will produce quality business and research-oriented documents.	Yes, final exam
	1.2. Students are able to professionally present their ideas and also logically explain and defend their argument.	Yes, case discussion
2. Our graduates will be skilled in team work and leadership.	2.1. Students will be able to lead and participate in group for projects, discussion, and presentation.	Yes, case discussion
	2.2. Students will be able to apply leadership theories and related skills.	No
3. Our graduates will be trained in ethics.	3.1. In a case setting, students will use appropriate techniques to analyze business problems to provide a solution and defend it.	Yes, case discussion
	3.2. Our students will practice ethics in the duration of the program.	Yes, classroom and case discussion
4. Our graduates will have a global perspective.	4.1. Students will have an international exposure.	Yes, classroom and case discussion
5. Our graduates will be skilled in problem-solving and critical thinking.	5.1. Our students will have a good understanding of decision tools in their fields.	Yes, classroom and case discussion
	5.2. Our students will be prepared to face problems in various business settings and find solutions.	Yes, classroom and case discussion
	5.3. Our students will demonstrate competency in critical thinking.	Yes, case discussion and final exam

2.2. Course specific objectives

After completing this course, students should be able to:

1. Understand the roles that Operations Management plays in a business. Integration of Operations decisions with Marketing and Finance decisions is critical. You will understand how Operations contributes to the success of the firm.
2. Understand the goals and objectives of Operations Management. We will discuss key decisions and trade-offs involved in effectively managing manufacturing and service operations.
3. Speak the language of Operations Management. You will become familiar with many special terms and concepts common to OM.
4. Learn OM techniques that are essential to products/services design, operations process design, management and improvement.

2.3. Assessment/Grading Details

There will be several case assignments and a final examination. The breakdown towards the final grade is as follows:

WEIGHTS ON COURSE REQUIREMENTS	PERCENTAGE
Class Participation	**10%**
Case Homework	**40%**
Quiz on Google Classroom	*30%*
In-class Discussion	*10%*
Final Exam	**50%**
Total	**100%**

Class Participation

Class participation is an important part of management courses. The learning experience of this course depends on your participation. I expect you to have read the assigned materials prior to class. Your goal should be to prepare consistently for the class, and to participate appropriately in the variety of activities in the course – lecture, discussions, group exercises, etc. Class will begin promptly at the scheduled time. Please arrive on time and allow yourself enough time to settle in before class starts. Remember that if you are not present, you may miss opportunities to participate, which can negatively affect your class participation and discussion grade. Any lateness longer than 20 minutes without **prior permission** will be considered an absence, resulting in a deduction of 5 point. Please note that grades will be reduced for students with repeated or unexcused absences and report to the school. Please note, asking for leave request after the class has concluded will **NOT** be permitted.

Whenever you know in advance that you will be absent, please let me know. If you miss class due to a pressing emergency, please provide me with the necessary documentation to excuse your absence (pending approval from the school). If you need to leave early for something that is an extremely unusual and unavoidable situation, you should explain your reason for leaving early to the professor ahead of time, and should sit near the door so your departure is not a distraction for others. Any absence longer than 20 minutes will be considered an absence.

We will discuss cases and news/academic articles in class, as well as have guest speakers. The frequency as well as quality of your questions/comments during discussion and Q&A with guest speakers will be reflected in the participation & discussion grade. If you only attend the sessions without participating in any discussion, you will not gain points in participation & discussion.

Guest Speakers

Our guest speakers are distinguished industry professionals who generously volunteer their time to contribute to this course. Out of respect for their commitment, students are expected to attend these sessions with the same level of professionalism as all other class meetings. Students should prepare in advance by reviewing relevant materials and formulating thoughtful questions. The perspectives offered by guest speakers are intended to complement and enrich the theoretical frameworks discussed in class.

Case Analyses

Number of Cases: **Eight cases total**

Weight per Case: **5% of your final grade each**

Total Weight: **40% of your final grade**

Before Each Class Session:

Read and analyse the assigned case thoroughly

Prepare for class discussion

Complete the **online quiz** before the deadline

During Class Discussion:

Participate in case discussions or in-class presentation

Your contributions count toward your grade

Exam

It is important to understand basic concepts. There will be a final-term exam. The exam is **closed-book** and will consist of multiple-choice questions and short essay questions. The exam will include material covered in the class (including cases) as well as in the required assigned readings (e.g., textbook, articles). The exam will occur in at 14:00 on **21 April 2026**. Due to the nature of the exam and class, there won't be a make-up exam. Please avoid any time conflicts (e.g., travel schedule or conflict with other courses/exams). The location and detailed arrangements will be announced as time approaches. No cheat sheet is allowed. You are allowed to bring a calculator (mobile phone is not allowed).

2.4 Academic Honesty and Plagiarism

It is important for a student's effort and credit to be recognized through class assessment. Credits earned for a student work due to efforts done by others are clearly unfair. Deliberate dishonesty is

considered academic misconducts, which include plagiarism; cheating on assignments or examinations; engaging in unauthorized collaboration on academic work; taking, acquiring, or using test materials without faculty permission; submitting false or incomplete records of academic achievement; acting alone or in cooperation with another to falsify records or to dishonestly obtain grades, honours, awards, or professional endorsement; or altering, forging, or misusing a University academic record; or fabricating or falsifying of data, research procedures, or data analysis.

All assessments are subject to academic misconduct check. Misconduct check may include reproducing the assessment, providing a copy to another member of faculty, and/or communicate a copy of this assignment to the PHBS Discipline Committee. A suspected plagiarized document/assignment submitted to a plagiarism checking service may be kept in its database for future reference purpose.

Where violation is suspected, penalties will be implemented. The penalties for academic misconduct may include: deduction of honour points, a mark of zero on the assessment, a fail grade for the whole course, and reference of the matter to the Peking University Registrar.

AI tools requirements:
Using AI tools to complete assignments or assessments without the approval of the course instructor and without authorization will be regarded as an act of academic dishonesty. Depending on the severity of the situation, penalties will be implemented in accordance with the provisions of the Peking University Graduate Student Handbook.

3. Topics, Teaching and Assessment Schedule

A tentative course schedule is as follows:

	Date	Topics
1	23/02/2026	Introduction of Operation Management; Fundamentals of Process
2	26/02/2026	Strategy and sustainability- Project Management
3	02/03/2026	Capacity Management
4	05/03/2026	Production Process
5	09/03/2026	Production Process II
6	12/03/2026	Service Process
7	16/03/2026	Service Process II
8	19/03/2026	Quality Management (Guest Speaker)
9	23/03/2026	Lean Supply Chain
10	26/03/2026	Logistics and Distribution (Guest Speaker)
11	30/03/2026	Logistics and Distribution II
12	02/04/2026	Global Sourcing and SCM
	06/04/2026	*Easter Monday*
13	08/04/2026	Forecasting
14	09/04/2026	Inventory Control & Wrap Up